Keys and Secrets Setup Guide

How to create every account, key and secret Agency Hub needs, step by step, and how to hand them over safely.

Agency Hub · Platforms: Firebase, Google Cloud (Sheets), Gmail, n8n, hosting · Version 1.0, October 2026

Before you start

Agency Hub connects to a few outside services. Each one needs its own account and one or more keys. This guide shows where to click to create each key and what to send to the Agency Hub team.

- SECRET values work like passwords. Anyone who has them can read your data or send email as you.
- NOT SECRET values identify your project. They are safe to share because they are visible in the website anyway.

> **If Agency Hub hosts the system for you,** you only need two sections: **section 3** (share your Google Sheet) and **section 4** (an email address to send codes from). The Agency Hub team handles the rest.

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1. Safe-handling rules

- **Never send secrets by email, WhatsApp, SMS or chat.** Use a password manager's secure share (1Password, Bitwarden Send, LastPass) or a one-time secret link that expires after it is opened.
- **Never put secrets in documents, screenshots or code.** Key files (`.json`) go straight from your computer into the secure share, then get deleted from Downloads.
- **One key per purpose.** Don't reuse the same password or key in two places, so one can be replaced without breaking the other.
- **Use a company account, not a personal one**, so access doesn't leave with an employee. For example, `it@youragency.co.il`.
- **If a secret leaks, replace it right away.** Each section below says how. Then tell the Agency Hub team, so the new value can be installed.

2. Firebase: login and database

Firebase stores user accounts (email/password and Google login) and the agency's data. Create it with the company Google account at console.firebase.google.com. The free Spark plan is enough to start.

2.1 Create the project

1. Click **Create a project**, give it a name (for example `youragency-hub`) and finish the wizard. Google Analytics is optional.
2. Open **Build** → **Firestore Database** → **Create database**, choose **production mode** and a region near you (for example `europe-west1`).

2.2 Turn on login methods

1. Open **Build** → **Authentication** → **Get started**.
2. Under **Sign-in method**, enable **Email/Password** and **Google**. For Google, choose a support email and save.
3. Under **Settings** → **Authorized domains**, add the website's address, for example `youragency.co.il` or `youragency.github.io`.

2.3 Web app settings NOT SECRET

1. Open **Project settings** (gear icon) → **General** → **Your apps** → the web icon `</>`. Register an app named `web`. Hosting is not needed.
2. Copy the values from the `firebaseConfig` box that appears:
   - `apiKey`, `authDomain`, `projectId`, `appId`

> The Firebase `apiKey` only identifies the project, so it is not a password. Security comes from the login rules and the server.

2.4 Server key (service account) SECRET

1. Open **Project settings** → **Service accounts**.
2. Click **Generate new private key** → **Generate key**. A `.json` file downloads.
3. Send this file through a secure share (section 1), then delete it from your computer.

> **This file gives full control of the Firebase project.** If it leaks: in the same screen, open **Manage service account permissions**, find the key under the service account's **Keys** tab, delete it, and generate a new one.

3. Google Sheets: lead data

Agency Hub reads leads and customers from a Google Sheet. It uses a "reader" robot account (a *service account*) that can only read the sheets you share with it. It has no other access to your Google account.

3a. If Agency Hub hosts the system (most customers)

1. Open your sheet in Google Sheets and click **Share**.
2. Add the reader email address the Agency Hub team gives you (it ends in `.iam.gserviceaccount.com`) as **Viewer**. Untick "Notify people".
3. Send the team the sheet's link NOT SECRET. The link alone gives no access, because the sheet stays private.

> To stop access at any time, remove the reader email from the sheet's **Share** list.

3b. If you run your own copy: create the reader account

Use console.cloud.google.com. The Firebase project from section 2 already appears there, so select it at the top.

1. **APIs & Services** → **Library** → search for **Google Sheets API** → **Enable**.
2. **IAM & Admin** → **Service Accounts** → **Create service account**. Name it `agency-hub-sheets`, click **Create and continue**, **skip the role step** (no roles needed) and click **Done**.
3. Open the new account → **Keys** → **Add key** → **Create new key** → **JSON**. A `.json` file downloads SECRET.
4. Copy the account's email (`agency-hub-sheets@…iam.gserviceaccount.com`) NOT SECRET and share each sheet with it as Viewer (as in 3a).

> If **Create new key** is blocked with a message about an organization policy, your Google Workspace administrator has turned off key creation. Ask them to allow it for this one project (policy `iam.disableServiceAccountKeyCreation`).

Replace a leaked key: on the service account's **Keys** tab, delete the old key and create a new one.

4. Gmail: sending signup codes

When someone signs up, Agency Hub emails them a 6-digit code. It needs an email account to send from, ideally a dedicated one such as `noreply.youragency@gmail.com`.

Option A: Gmail or Google Workspace (simplest)

1. Sign in to Google **as the sending account**. If several accounts are signed in, check the profile picture in the corner, because an app password works only for the account that created it.
2. Turn on 2-Step Verification: myaccount.google.com/signinoptions/twosv.
3. Open myaccount.google.com/apppasswords, enter the name `Agency Hub` and click **Create**.
4. Copy the 16-letter password SECRET. Google shows it only once.

SETTING	VALUE
Server (SMTP host)	`smtp.gmail.com`
Port	`587`
Username	the full sending address
Password	the 16-letter app password, **not** the normal Gmail password
Sender name	for example `Your Agency <noreply.youragency@gmail.com>`

> **"App passwords" missing?** Either 2-Step Verification is off, or it's a Google Workspace account whose administrator disabled app passwords. Ask the administrator, or use option B.

Replace a leaked password: delete it on the App passwords page and create a new one.

Option B: an email-sending service

Services like Brevo, Resend or SendGrid deliver more reliably at higher volume. Create an account, verify your domain as they instruct, then copy their **SMTP host, port, username and password** from the SMTP settings page. They use the same fields as the table above.

5. n8n: AI assistant and automations

n8n runs the workflows, including the chat assistant inside Agency Hub. Use n8n Cloud at n8n.io, or your own server.

5.1 Google Sheets connection inside n8n SECRET

On n8n Cloud: go to **Credentials → Add credential → Google Sheets OAuth2 API**, click **Sign in with Google**, choose the account that owns the sheets and allow access. No keys need to be copied.

On your own n8n server, create a Google login client first:

1. In Google Cloud console, enable **Google Sheets API** and **Google Drive API** (**APIs & Services → Library**).
2. **APIs & Services → OAuth consent screen**: choose *Internal* (Workspace) or *External*, fill in the app name and support email, and add yourself as a test user.
3. **APIs & Services → Credentials → Create credentials → OAuth client ID → Web application**. Under *Authorized redirect URIs*, paste the **OAuth Redirect URL** shown in n8n's credential window.
4. Copy the **Client ID** and **Client secret** into the n8n credential, then click **Sign in with Google**.

5.2 AI model key SECRET

1. Example with OpenAI: platform.openai.com/api-keys → **Create new secret key** → copy it. It is shown only once.
2. In n8n: **Credentials → Add credential → OpenAI** → paste the key.
3. Set a monthly spending limit under the provider's **Billing → Limits**.

5.3 Chat link for the website NOT SECRET

1. Open the assistant workflow and its **Chat Trigger** node.
2. Turn on **Make Chat Publicly Available** and set **Mode** to **Embedded Chat**.
3. In **Allowed Origins (CORS)**, enter the website address, for example `https://youragency.co.il`.
4. Save, then **activate / publish** the workflow. The chat only works on the published version.
5. Copy the **Chat URL** (it looks like `https://…/webhook/…/chat`) and send it to the team.

> The chat link is visible inside the website, so it is not secret. Keep the workflow limited to reading what the assistant needs.

5.4 Shared secret for future automations SECRET

Later phases will let n8n send data to Agency Hub. Both sides then need the same long random value (`N8N_SECRET`, 32+ characters). Create one with a password manager's generator (64 characters, letters and numbers), then store it in the password manager. It will be pasted into both n8n and the server.

6. Hosting settings

This section applies only if you host Agency Hub yourself. The server (for example on Render, Cloud Run or a VPS) reads its keys from **environment variables**, which are set in the hosting dashboard and never written in code. On Render this is **your service → Environment → Add environment variable**. Save, then redeploy.

VARIABLE	VALUE

`NODE_ENV`	`production`
`FIREBASE_PROJECT_ID`	project ID from 2.3
`FIREBASE_WEB_API_KEY`	`apiKey` from 2.3
`FIREBASE_SERVICE_ACCOUNT_JSON`	entire contents of the file from 2.4 SECRET
`SHEETS_SERVICE_ACCOUNT_JSON`	entire contents of the file from 3b SECRET
`CORS_ORIGINS`	the website address, for example `https://youragency.co.il`
`SMTP_HOST`, `SMTP_PORT`, `SMTP_USER`, `MAIL_FROM`	from section 4
`SMTP_PASS`	app password from section 4 SECRET
`N8N_SECRET`	from 5.4, when that feature is enabled SECRET

> For the two `..._JSON` variables, paste the **whole file content**, from the first `{` to the last `}`. Pasting just the email address is a common mistake and won't work.

7. Summary: where every value goes

VALUE	FROM	TYPE	USED BY
Firebase web config (`apiKey`, `authDomain`, `projectId`, `appId`)	Firebase → Project settings → Your apps	NOT SECRET	Website build
Firebase service account file	Firebase → Project settings → Service accounts	SECRET	Server
Authorized domain	Firebase → Authentication → Settings	NOT SECRET	Google login
Sheets reader file	Google Cloud → Service Accounts → Keys	SECRET	Server
Sheets reader email	Google Cloud → Service Accounts	NOT SECRET	Share each sheet with it
Google Sheet link	Google Sheets address bar	NOT SECRET	Agency Hub settings
Email app password	Google Account → App passwords	SECRET	Server (signup codes)
n8n Google credential	n8n → Credentials (Sign in with Google)	SECRET	Stays inside n8n
Google OAuth Client ID + secret (own n8n server only)	Google Cloud → Credentials	SECRET	Stays inside n8n
AI model API key	AI provider dashboard	SECRET	Stays inside n8n
n8n chat URL	n8n → Chat Trigger node	NOT SECRET	Website build
`N8N_SECRET`	Password manager generator	SECRET	Server and n8n

8. Handover checklist

- ☐ Firebase project created with the company account; Firestore in production mode
- ☐ Email/Password and Google login enabled; website domain added to Authorized domains
- ☐ Firebase web config sent (not secret)
- ☐ Firebase service account file sent through a secure share, then deleted locally
- ☐ Google Sheet shared with the reader email as Viewer; sheet link sent
- ☐ Sending email chosen; 2-Step Verification on; app password sent through a secure share
- ☐ n8n: Google Sheets credential connected; AI key added with a spending limit
- ☐ n8n chat: public, Embedded mode, website in Allowed Origins, workflow published; chat URL sent
- ☐ All secrets stored in the company password manager, nowhere else

> Questions, or something looks different on screen? Platforms rename menus from time to time. Search the platform's help for the item name in bold, or contact the Agency Hub team. Never send a secret to ask the question.